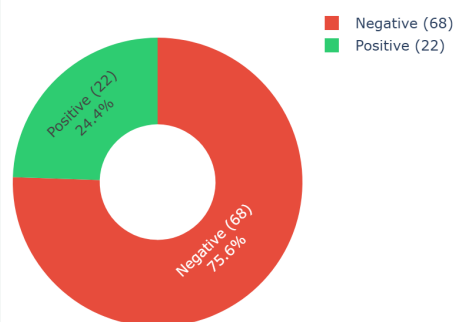


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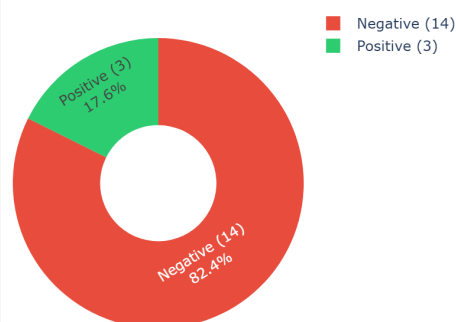
14 Mar - 16 March 2026

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Executive Summaries

16 March 2026:

Facing escalating global energy shocks and domestic economic strain, Pakistan's survival hinges on accelerating domestic production, expanding renewables, and restoring policy coherence. With LNG imports halved and global oil volatility soaring, the country faces inflation, debt, and trade deficits. While solar now powers 74% of electricity, investment stalls due to regulatory uncertainty and judicial pauses on IPP taxation. Subsidies, pipeline explorations, and IMF silence compound risks. Without urgent, coordinated action to insulate the economy from global shocks, GDP contraction looms — and the nation's resilience depends on domestic energy development, fiscal discipline, and a unified policy framework.

15 March 2026:

Pakistan's energy sector faces existential strain amid volatile global markets, geopolitical shocks, and domestic policy inertia. Rising fuel prices, subsidy burdens, and supply chain bottlenecks threaten inflation, power generation, and the \$6bn current account deficit. While digital monitoring and renewables aim to bolster security, stalled reforms and import diversification fail to offset fragility. U.S. energy dominance—via LNG deals, SMRs, and “drill, baby, drill”—intensifies global supply risks, forcing Pakistan into deeper economic vulnerability. Industry leaders warn of collapse, demanding urgent reform, infrastructure, and realignment to avert crisis amid escalating global volatility and rising energy insecurity.

14 March 2026:

Pakistan navigates a volatile energy landscape amid global supply shocks and fiscal strain, aggressively pivoting to renewables (74% generation, targeting 96% by 2934) while reducing LNG dependence to 10%. Facing deep fiscal crisis and rising fuel prices—spiked to \$140/barrel—government pauses petrol/diesel hikes and seeks debt relief via LNG savings and fuel levies. Simultaneously, Punjab's groundwater crisis drives solar tubewell adoption, while EV incentives and court rulings affirm NEPRA's power dispute authority. Despite dealer-led price protests and legal challenges, energy stability is maintained through reserves, digital dashboards, and supply chain coordination, as global energy shifts accelerate Pakistan's push for clean, resilient, and austere energy governance.

Key Energy Topics

Net Metering

Why does the port of Fujairah matter to the oil market?

UAE's Fujairah port, a critical crude and fuel hub near Hormuz, halted operations after a drone attack. With 1.7Mbpd exports and major blending/storage capacity, disruptions threaten global supply amid Iran war-induced Strait closures, forcing UAE to reroute via ADCOP pipeline—potentially impacting OPEC production and global fuels markets....

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Tribune

Negative

Rising global oil prices pose serious risks to economic recovery: BMP - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan warns of severe economic fallout from rising oil prices amid regional tensions. GDP risks contraction; import bills surge, widening current account deficit. Urgent push for renewables (hydro, solar, wind, nuclear) and infrastructure upgrades to reduce reliance on imports and build long-term resilience....

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Business Recorder

Negative

India may soften new grid-supply rules for renewable power producers - Markets - Business Recorder

India may soften penalties for wind/solar producers under stricter grid-supply rules, delaying enforcement until after April 2026. Industry warns of revenue losses; government deferred implementation to support forecasting improvements and investment. India aims to reach 500 GW non-fossil capacity by 2030....

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Business Recorder

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Solarization

Where does Thar Coal fit into Pakistan's energy independence pipe dream?

Qatar's LNG exports disrupted by regional conflict, impacting Pakistan and Bangladesh reliant on Gulf gas. Pakistan's grid stability hinges on 10% LNG, with solar rising to 74% of electricity generation. LNG use has fallen 50% since 2021, highlighting renewables' growing role amid supply chain vulnerabilities....

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Boosting farm competitiveness - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's agriculture faces severe cost pressures from rising diesel prices, climate risks, and subsidy cuts. Electric tractors—especially for small farms—are a viable, low-cost alternative to diesel, yet the government's energy policy ignores them. Solar-powered irrigation systems offer partial support, but subsidies should shift toward electrifying tractors to boost resilience, reduce imports, and safeguard food security....

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Oil shock and the import trap

Middle East conflict fuels oil volatility, straining Pakistan's economy via soaring fuel imports and trade deficits. LNG reliance on Gulf exports through Hormuz adds risk. Renewables—especially solar—are critical to reduce vulnerability; policymakers must accelerate adoption of EVs and invest in domestic energy sources to mitigate external shocks and balance-of-payments risks....

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Privatisation

'Worst nightmare': anger and frustration as Gulf states bear brunt of war they did not start

UAE and Gulf states face severe economic and security disruptions amid escalating Iran-U.S. conflict, with oil exports slashed and ports like Ras Al Khaimah and Fujairah targeted. Military tensions, drone attacks, and Hormuz Strait blockades have strained U.S. alliances, prompting Gulf states to seek strategic autonomy while bearing heavy defense costs and economic losses....

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The Guardian

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Jamshoro Power Company Ltd protests to Railways over delay in coal supply - Business - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's Jamshoro Power Plant faces closure risks due to alleged rail transport delays by Pakistan Railways, citing non-payment of freight charges. JPCL disputes blame, noting contractual obligations and operational differences from Sahiwal. Renewables not mentioned; financial and logistics tensions persist amid coal supply disruptions....

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Dawn

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US assures of ‘reliable’ energy supply to Asia-Pacific - World - DAWN.COM

U.S. energy dominance amid Middle East conflict: Surge in oil prices, halted Hormuz traffic, and U.S. pledges to secure Asia-Pacific supply. \$30B+ deals announced; Japan invests \$550B for tariff relief. Renewables push via SMR partnerships (Hitachi, GE Vernova); LNG deal with Hanwha. Trump’s “drill, baby, drill” policy boosts oil profits amid global mineral and energy diversification efforts....

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Venture Global sees global LNG prices volatility ‘very short-term’, CEO says - Markets - Business Recorder

LNG prices in Asia dipped slightly amid Middle East supply disruptions, with Qatar’s facilities offline. Venture Global confirms expansion of its U.S. LNG project, set to boost global supply and stabilize long-term prices. Market analysts view current volatility as short-term, with renewed confidence in future energy market stability....

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War Diary Day 15: Strikes on Iran’s Kharg Island escalate energy war - World - DAWN.COM

US strikes Kharg Island to signal pressure amid Iran’s retaliatory operations across Gulf, Iraq, Lebanon, and Yemen. Energy markets remain volatile as oil exports intact, but strategic disruptions threaten global trade. Renewables gain traction as geopolitical tensions escalate, with regional alliances expanding and energy infrastructure targeted to amplify economic stakes....

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Tariff Hikes

Fuel Price Adjustment

Load Shedding

PCDMA says Rs55 fuel price hike hurting trade, raising business costs

Pakistan's petroleum price hike (Rs55/litre) is straining industry, with trade groups warning of rising costs, inflation, and export decline. Industry leaders urge urgent government intervention to stabilize energy prices and reduce business burdens, citing electricity tariff cuts as temporary relief amid persistent fuel cost pressures....

[Read More →](#) Profit Pakistan **Negative**

Hiked POL prices begin to inflict serious damage on economy, warns PCDMA - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's sudden Rs55/litre petrol-diesel hike threatens industries, urging government to stabilize energy prices. PCDMA warns rising costs risk inflation, export decline, and economic instability, calling for urgent policy realignment to support trade and industrial recovery amid already high electricity and raw material costs....

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The electrostate rises

China leads as the global "electrostate," dominating clean energy supply chains—rare earths, solar panels, batteries—driving its growth. Fossil fuel states face decline as renewables undercut their power. Geopolitics now hinges on critical minerals and tech infrastructure, not oil, reshaping alliances and dependencies in a geography-driven new era of global dominance....

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Global Diesel Prices Cross \$140 Per Barrel, Highest Since 2022

Global diesel prices surged to \$140/barrel amid Middle East tensions, impacting Pakistan's economy. Local prices rose to Rs. 335/litre, threatening inflation. Renewables remain underdeveloped, while geopolitical disruptions and shipping costs drive energy volatility—a critical concern for energy-dependent nations like Pakistan....

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The price of war

Geopolitical tensions in the Gulf threaten Pakistan's energy and supply chains, driving up fuel, food, and pharmaceutical costs. Fuel scarcity risks disrupting transport and telecom services, while import-dependent sectors face cascading price hikes. Economic vulnerability amplifies these shocks, with rising global freight costs and insurance premiums further straining a debt-laden economy....

[Read More →](#) Tribune **Negative**

No let-up in ME tensions: RLNG supply crunch hits power sector hard - Business Recorder

Pakistan faces severe RLNG shortages due to Qatar's halted LNG exports amid Middle East conflict, risking power generation. Gov't explores spot LNG but finds it unviable vs. RFO costs. Export of furnace oil banned pending PM approval. High-efficiency RLNG plants remain critical; load shedding may follow if supply persists....

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PHC rules civil courts lack jurisdiction in load shedding disputes

Peshawar High Court upholds NEPRA's exclusive jurisdiction over electricity matters, rejecting civil court intervention in load shedding disputes. Ruling reinforces regulatory autonomy, citing constitutional and statutory frameworks, limiting judicial involvement to administrative power sector decisions under the NEPRA Act 1997....

[Read More →](#) Tribune **Negative**

Courts have no jurisdiction to decide issues related to power outages: Peshawar High Court - Pakistan - DAWN.COM

Peshawar High Court reaffirms Nepra's exclusive jurisdiction over power disputes, barring civil courts from adjudicating loadshedding grievances. Petitioners must approach Nepra under statutory rules; the ruling underscores regulatory authority and consumer protection frameworks in Pakistan's energy sector....

[Read More →](#) Dawn **Negative**

Solar, wind boost energy security: power minister - Business - DAWN.COM

Pakistan is reducing LNG dependence by boosting domestic renewables (solar, wind, hydro, nuclear, coal) to 74% of generation, aiming for >96% by 2034. Surplus capacity and rooftop solar mitigate grid stress. LNG now accounts for just 10%, with 55% from clean sources. Battery storage and local energy security are key priorities amid global supply risks....

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Global shocks spark calls for Thar coal use

Pakistan seeks to reduce fuel vulnerability by accelerating Thar coal use across sectors, targeting power and cement industries. Despite rising imported coal prices, government efforts focus on blending mandates, easing financing hurdles, and boosting local bank lending—critical amid geopolitical risks and global energy volatility....

[Read More →](#) Tribune **Positive**

Pakistan, IMF and half-told fiscal story - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's fiscal crisis stems from weak tax collection, persistent losses in public enterprises, and unaddressed energy sector inefficiencies. IMF negotiations stall due to revenue shortfalls, but deeper reform requires tackling structural drains, privatizing loss-making firms, and rationalizing wasteful spending—otherwise, temporary relief will trigger recurring crises....

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LDO price hiked by Rs67.51 - Business Recorder

Pakistan's federal government raised LDO and kerosene prices amid rising global crude costs and geopolitical tensions. The move reflects inflationary pressure and fuel cost escalations, with no immediate change to renewables or financial results reported....

[Read More →](#) Business Recorder **Negative**

Oil shock may cost Pakistan 1.5pc of GDP: experts - Pakistan - DAWN.COM

Pakistan faces \$12–14bn external shock from soaring oil prices and remittance losses, risking a \$6bn current account deficit. Renewables and indigenous energy must rapidly expand to replace LNG reliance. IMF pressure may demand deeper concessions. Austerity measures are ineffective; real solutions require infrastructure investment, fuel price flexibility, and avoiding regional conflict escalation....

[Read More →](#) Dawn **Negative**

A smart response to oil shocks - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan faces sharp fuel price hikes amid global oil volatility, risking inflation and growth. Policymakers must balance fiscal discipline with economic resilience—leveraging renewables, biofuel blending, domestic gas/hydro, demand management, and protecting vulnerable households to mitigate shocks and build long-term energy security....

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Sri Lanka brings in four-day week to eke out stocks of oil and gas hit by Iran war

Middle East conflict disrupts global energy flows, triggering fuel shortages across South Asia. Sri Lanka cuts workdays, imposes rationing, and boosts domestic resilience. India negotiates tanker passage through Hormuz, easing some pressure. Renewables remain underutilized amid crisis, with governments prioritizing energy conservation over growth....

[Read More →](#) The Guardian **Negative**

Oil slips as Trump presses other countries to help secure Strait of Hormuz

Oil prices dipped amid geopolitical tensions over the Strait of Hormuz, following U.S.-Israeli strikes on Iran. The IEA released 400M barrels to stabilize markets. U.S. officials signal conflict may end in weeks, but risks remain high; renewables not mentioned....

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US oil CEOs warn Trump administration that energy crisis likely to worsen, WSJ reports

U.S. & Israeli strikes on Iran have disrupted Strait of Hormuz, threatening global oil flows. Trump urges allied nations to escort tankers; U.S. officials predict conflict ends in weeks, sparking price volatility. Iran denies negotiations, vows resilience. Renewables not mentioned; focus remains on geopolitical tension and energy market instability....

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RLNG consumption in power sector: Govt constitutes panel to craft operational plan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's government is forming a cross-sector committee to address RLNG underutilization amid declining power demand from rooftop solar. RLNG surpluses—due to reduced off-take and contractual obligations—are causing operational strain on gas pipelines and grid dispatch. The Federal Cabinet approved diverting 24–29 NPD cargoes, while PSO and PLL have already sold 11 cargoes; disputes persist over IGCEP compliance and demand flexibility....

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Power Div challenges AGP report - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's power sector sees reduced circular debt (Rs 780B) amid Disco inefficiencies, despite claims of structural reform. Power Division challenges Audit findings, citing K-Electric's debt contributions and tariff surcharge removal as part of a phased settlement plan over 5–6 years, aiming for long-term cost relief and operational improvement....

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Power generation merger hits bureaucratic roadblock - Business - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's energy task force approved merging redundant Gencos and GHCL into NPPMC to cut costs and streamline operations. Bureaucrats resist, citing perks and staffing; delays persist despite ministerial orders. Financial savings target over Rs4 trillion. Renewables not mentioned in this update....

[Read More →](#) Dawn **Negative**

Are fuel price increases making you cut back? We would like to hear from you

Middle East conflict disrupts oil flows, spiking global prices to \$100/barrel. India and Sri Lanka ration LPG/kerosene; Pakistan closes schools to cut fuel use. Consumers are reducing travel and cooking fuel, adapting to soaring costs amid energy market volatility....

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Pakistan Faces Huge Gas Crisis in April as Gulf War Disrupts LNG Supplies

Pakistan faces imminent gas shortages post-April 14 due to halted LNG imports from Qatar amid regional conflict. Authorities plan emergency allocations, reducing power sector supply while boosting domestic use. Alternative supplies via Azerbaijan are being explored at triple the cost. Renewables and efficiency measures will be critical to avoid energy crisis....

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A 'black swan' oil moment? – II - Opinion - Business Recorder

Global oil markets disrupted by Iran conflict; IEA releases 400Mbarrels amid supply shortages. Pakistan faces soaring fuel costs amid policy critique and climate vulnerability. IMF/World Bank silent on balance-of-payments crises. Renewables & resilience investments urged to reduce fossil reliance, curb inflation, and avoid stagflation....

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Biggest global oil supply disruptions in history

Strait of Hormuz closure triggers historic oil disruption; IEA releases 400Mbbl from stockpiles. Past crises (1973, 1979, 2022) show global reliance on emergency responses. Renewables gain traction amid supply volatility, with IEA's role pivotal in crisis coordination and market stabilization....

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Committee reviews fuel stock position, import arrangements

Pakistan's energy committee confirms stable petrol stocks amid global volatility, with coordinated supply efforts and digital monitoring systems. Finance Minister stresses domestic security and conservation measures to ease import pressure, while maintaining uninterrupted fuel access despite regional tensions....

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Shell says global LNG demand to rise at least 54% by 2040 - Markets - Business Recorder

Shell forecasts global LNG demand to rise 54–68% by 2040 (650–710 mtpa), driven by Asian demand, despite climate activist pressure. Shell defends its strategy as essential for energy balance and cost-effective, amid geopolitical volatility. Asia will drive 70% of growth; LNG is expected to exceed half of global gas demand growth through 2040....

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Governments worldwide move to cushion households from rising energy costs

Global governments respond to energy shocks with emergency measures: India boosts LPG production, Korea ramps nuclear/coal, China releases fertiliser reserves, Australia taps fuel stockpiles. EU relaxes import rules, Italy considers tax cuts, Malaysia and Brazil subsidise fuels, Philippines boosts coal, Egypt controls bread prices — all amid inflation and supply disruptions....

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Govt panel to prepare operational plan for LNG consumption in power sector amid shifting electricity demand patterns

Global governments respond to soaring energy prices with emergency measures: India boosts LPG production, Korea ramps up nuclear/coal, China releases fertiliser reserves, Australia taps domestic fuel stocks. EU relaxes import rules, Italy considers tax cuts, Malaysia and Brazil subsidise fuels, Ethiopia and Philippines curb inflation via subsidies and tariffs. Renewables not highlighted in key actions....

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Germany misses climate targets as emissions barely fall in 2025

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Oil prices rise after Trump claims US ‘totally demolished’ Iran’s Kharg Island export hub

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Replacing 1m petrol cars with EVs could cut Australia’s reliance on foreign fuel by 1bn litres a year

Australia is accelerating EV adoption amid global energy shocks, with experts linking rising petrol prices to increased EV sales. Replacing 1M cars with EVs could cut fuel reliance by 1bn litres/year, boosting energy sovereignty and net zero goals. Government incentives face scrutiny, but analysts urge swift action to mitigate future oil price volatility....

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PDP chief urges shift to domestic oil, gas for energy security

Pakistan's PDP urges domestic energy development amid Middle East instability, highlighting reliance on imports and untapped reserves in Sindh, Balochistan, and offshore areas. Regulatory uncertainty deters investment; government must prioritize policy stability to unlock hydrocarbon potential and reduce foreign exchange pressure from volatile global oil prices....

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Groundwater: the invisible lifeline Pakistan is squandering - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan's Punjab faces severe groundwater depletion due to over-extraction and climate stress, driving small farmers toward solar-powered tubewells despite legal vesting of rights. Governance gaps, unregulated pumping, and inefficient crop choices exacerbate the crisis—threatening water security by 2047 unless integrated aquifer management is enforced....

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Business
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Global energy shocks: Country has potential to reduce vulnerability: PDP - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's PDP chief urges boosting domestic oil/gas production amid Middle East crises, citing underinvestment, regulatory hurdles, and reliance on imports. He calls for stable policies, tech-driven exploration, infrastructure upgrades, and renewable diversification to secure energy independence and shield the economy from global shocks....

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Business
Recorder

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Power self-reliance - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Pakistan is accelerating its shift to domestic energy sources—nearly 75% now from indigenous generation—with solar, nuclear, and hydropower driving the transition. While boosting energy security, it's exacerbated grid strain, outages, and circular debt. New net-billing policies favor behind-the-meter solar, complicating revenue models and highlighting systemic delivery challenges despite renewables growth....

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Dawn

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The case of structural energy security - Business - DAWN.COM

Pakistan's energy system has quietly transformed through nuclear expansion, Thar coal ramp-up, and decentralized BTMsolar, boosting indigenous generation to 85% and reducing import reliance. Economic signals drove this shift, with policy now focused on integrating BTMcapacity, renegotiating RLNG contracts, and tackling distribution inefficiencies to unlock sustainable growth....

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How the war in Iran and its economic fallout could lead to Trump's defeat

Trump's energy strategy faces headwinds: rising U.S. gasoline prices, inflation pressures, and global supply disruptions. While domestic energy self-sufficiency and sanctions waivers offer short-term relief, prolonged conflict in the Middle East threatens economic stability. Public backlash and economic costs risk undermining Trump's approval, despite his confidence in military victory and energy market control....

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The Guardian

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Gas debt payment plan awaits IMF nod

Pakistan seeks IMF approval to retire Rs1.5T gas sector debt via LNG savings, dividends, and a petrol/diesel levy, amid IMF concerns over fiscal impact and dividend sustainability. Gas price hikes and LNG renegotiations with Qatar are key moves, aiming to reduce circular debt within 3 years while addressing energy cost pressures....

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Austerity plan: who will pay the cost? - Opinion - Business Recorder

Pakistan raised petrol prices by 25% amid Middle East tensions, boosting petroleum levy revenue but risking public hardship. Austerity measures cut government spending and staff salaries, with IMF urging fiscal consolidation. Renewables not mentioned; energy inflation pressures persist as GDP growth faces global risks....

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Cabinet committee approves draft amendments to customs law to support EV policy

The Pakistani government is finalizing legislative amendments to align customs duty concessions for electric vehicles under AIDEP 2021–26, addressing gaps in EV-part coverage. Approved by CCLC, the changes aim to boost local EV manufacturing and export growth through clearer fiscal incentives, pending federal cabinet approval....

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Petrol price committee reports comfortable fuel reserves amid regional volatility - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's energy sector remains stable amid global volatility, with sufficient petroleum stocks and coordinated supply chains. The Finance Ministry monitors markets daily, plans for imports, and promotes conservation. A digital dashboard is being developed to enhance oversight—ensuring uninterrupted fuel access while safeguarding economic stability....

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Business Recorder

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Petroleum products: Supply chains functional, panel told - Business Recorder

Pakistan's energy committee confirms stable petroleum stocks amid global volatility, prioritizing supply chain continuity. Proactive import arrangements, digital monitoring, and conservation measures are in place. Government emphasizes coordination across sectors to safeguard energy security and economic stability during regional market disruptions....

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Business Recorder

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Measures proposed to help control expected energy crisis - Pakistan - Business Recorder

Pakistan's government halted further petrol price hikes amid rising inflation and debt concerns. Maulana Bashir Farooq urged policy reforms: petrol quotas for multi-vehicle households, carpooling during office hours, and subsidized fuel for motorcycle riders. He warned of economic collapse if prices soar to Rs500/litre, urging PM Shehbaz Sharif to consult experts to prevent deeper debt and industrial decline....

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IHC suspends FBR's Super Tax notices to 3 IPPs - Business Recorder

Islamabad High Court suspends Super Tax recovery notices against three IPPs due to procedural violations under Pakistan's Income Tax Ordinance. The court highlights legal non-compliance with mandatory notice requirements, despite FCC rulings binding the tax department — raising concerns over renewables sector fairness and constitutional rights....

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Business Recorder

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Dealing with vulnerabilities - Newspaper - DAWN.COM

Gulf conflict threatens Pakistan's energy security, driving up oil prices and inflation. Urgent reforms include deregulating fuel pricing, boosting domestic gas/refinery output, and expanding renewables/transmission. Fiscal discipline, export support, remittance resilience, and FDI attraction are key to mitigating external shocks and enhancing long-term economic resilience....

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'Govt absorbs Rs77 fuel price hike'

Pakistan's government absorbed Rs77/litre diesel and Rs48/litre petrol price hikes to avoid consumer spikes, but lacks clarity on how it will offset costs. Industry warns of supply chain strain, misleading social media comparisons (Brent vs Dubai benchmarks), and stalled policies like Brownfield Refining. State-owned firms dominate, and pricing is based on refined product indices—not crude alone....

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Tribune

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Petroleum dealers demand govt increase margins - Markets - Business Recorder

Pakistan's PPDA demands an 8% margin hike amid fuel price hikes and operational costs, threatening nationwide petrol pump closures on March 27. Dealers accuse oil marketers of quota restrictions and hoarding; they've urged government inquiry and legal action. Eid临近 adds urgency to negotiations....

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Misc

LHC stays recovery of electricity duty from oil and gas companies

Lahore High Court suspends electricity duty collection from oil/gas firms amid constitutional challenge, citing Supreme Court precedent. Petitioners argue amendments violate binding judicial rulings; court grants interim relief, halting enforcement pending further review....

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Pakistan seeks IMF approval for Rs1.5 trillion plan to retire gas sector circular debt

Pakistan seeks IMF approval to retire Rs1.5T gas sector debt via dividends, LNG savings, and a Rs5/litre fuel levy—raising concerns over financial health and consumer costs. The IMF urges clarity on dividend impacts and LNG use. Debt stems from price differentials; government pledges annual tariff revisions to prevent further accumulation....

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Govt to pay Rs23bn to OMCs to keep petrol, diesel prices unchanged

Pakistan's government maintains petrol/diesel prices unchanged amid rising global oil costs, compensating OMCs with Rs23B via OGRA. Funded by a newly approved austerity fund, this move aims to curb inflation but strains public finances. No major renewables developments reported....

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IEA to release 271.7 million barrels from strategic reserves after Middle East supply disruption

IEA coordinates largest-ever strategic oil release (271.7M bbl) amid Middle East conflict disruption, targeting Asia/Oceania first. Prices remain near \$100/bbl despite supply shock; restoring Hormuz shipping and insurance is critical for recovery. First such release since 2022 Ukraine war....

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Govt Decides to Maintain Over Rs. 100 Levy on Petrol

Govt maintains petrol/diesel levies at Rs. 105.37/dl & Rs. 55.24/dl, subsidizing with Rs. 23B via OGRA. Cabinet approves Rs. 27.1B Austerity Fund; DG Oil directs OGRA on payment mechanism. No major renewables or financial results highlighted in this update....

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Govt Prepares 10-Year Plan to Eliminate Rs. 3.4 Trillion Gas Circular Debt

Pakistan's government plans to clear over Rs1.5 trillion in gas sector circular debt via phased payments, a Rs5/litre fuel levy, and surcharge waivers, with IMF approval pending. The move aims to stabilize the energy sector amid rising liabilities of Rs3.4 trillion, targeting financial restructuring and long-term sustainability....

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Govt freezes petrol prices despite global uptick

Pakistan's PM Shehbaz Sharif halted fuel price hikes amid global oil volatility, prioritizing public relief amid economic strain. The move follows recent austerity measures and diplomatic efforts to secure crude supplies. Government aims to stabilize prices through fiscal discipline, with hopes for global recovery....

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Petroleum dealers warn of strike from 27th

Pakistan's petroleum dealers threaten nationwide pump closures if government fails to raise margins to 8%, citing plummeting profits amid rising fuel prices. They accuse oil marketers of quota-based shortages and Iranian fuel imports, warning of potential price hikes and market chaos unless intervention occurs....

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Five killed in Russian air attacks on Ukraine

Russia launched heavy attacks on Ukraine's energy infrastructure, killing five and disrupting power across six regions. Ukraine retaliates with strikes on Russian targets. NATO allies bolster defenses amid Iran conflict distraction. Renewables remain key as Russia's winter campaign weakens Ukrainian resilience—though no major renewables breakthroughs reported....

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Fuel price hike starts hurting economy

Pakistan's Rs55/litre petroleum price hike has alarmed businesses, with PCDMA warning of severe economic damage. Traders face unsustainable costs, threatening commerce. The association urges PM Shehbaz Sharif to act swiftly to alleviate the financial strain amid ongoing economic pressures. No renewables or financial results mentioned....

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Tribune

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Petroleum products: Current prices will be maintained despite global hike: PM - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan's PM Shehbaz Sharif maintains petroleum prices amid rising global oil costs, citing economic stability and austerity measures. Government efforts to ensure supply and price control are emphasized, with optimism for future stabilization. No price hikes announced despite regional tensions and global pressures....

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Business Recorder

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Fuel prices unchanged for week despite global oil spike - Markets - Business Recorder

Pakistan’s government has paused petrol and diesel price hikes, maintaining HSD at Rs335.86/litre and petrol at Rs321.17/litre amid rising global oil prices and regional instability. PM Shehbaz Sharif cited economic hardship and fiscal discipline as reasons for the decision, emphasizing austerity measures to shield citizens....

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Nora EV enters Pakistan market with Rs1.89mn starting price - Business & Finance - Business Recorder

Pakistan’s Nora EV launches at Rs1.89M, offering battery-swapping tech and 120-300km range, targeting urban buyers amid rising fuel costs. UK EV sales hit record highs in 2025. Chinese delegation visits Bol to explore EV opportunities, signaling global interest in Pakistan’s green mobility growth....

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Selective exceptions, strategic consequences - Editorials - Business Recorder

Pakistan objects to India-Canada’s uranium supply deal, citing unfairness in global nuclear cooperation. The agreement grants India privileged access amid partial non-compliance with IAEA safeguards, raising proliferation and strategic stability concerns. Pakistan urges a rules-based, non-discriminatory framework for civilian nuclear trade....

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US natural gas futures slide - Markets - Business Recorder

US natural gas futures dipped on mild March weather easing demand, with storage injections boosting supplies. Gas prices remain stable amid pipeline constraints and low export capacity. Global gas prices rose sharply post-Iran war, but US markets reacted less due to self-sufficiency. Renewables not mentioned; focus remains on gas supply, weather, and geopolitical impacts....

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No hike in petrol and HSD prices, PD decides - Business Recorder

Pakistan maintains petrol & diesel prices amid rising Petroleum Levy (PL) from Rs84.40 to Rs105.37/litre, boosting non-tax revenue toward IMF targets. Dealers urge higher margins; GST remains zero, limiting tax burden. PL collection exceeds budgeted targets, with renewables not mentioned in this update....

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Iran holds the key to reopening global energy markets - Markets - Business Recorder

Gulf tensions escalate as Iran disrupts oil flows via Hormuz, forcing global markets to rely on uncertain routes. U.S.-led efforts to restore shipping face resistance from Tehran; insurers and exporters warn of prolonged risks. Renewables gain less attention amid supply chaos, while geopolitical uncertainty undermines energy market confidence....

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Govt to absorb Rs23bn hit to keep fuel prices unchanged - Business Recorder

Pakistan absorbs Rs23B subsidy to stabilize fuel prices amid Strait of Hormuz disruptions; explores Red Sea & UAE pipelines. Oil imports via alternative routes face logistical hurdles. Russian crude deemed unviable due to refinery incompatibility and carbon levy. Renewables not highlighted; financial strain persists despite austerity fund allocation....

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Mounting gas shortages disrupt some steel plants at India's JSW, one unit may face shutdown - World - Business Recorder

India faces severe gas shortages due to Middle East conflict disruptions, threatening steel plants like JSW Group and risking supply chain collapse. Emergency measures limit gas use to critical sectors; industry urges fast-tracked imports. Panic buying fuels LPG demand, while small producers warn of halts—highlighting renewables' urgent need to offset fossil fuel reliance....

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Pakistan's energy security remains stable as authorities confirm sufficient fuel reserves and imports for March–April, with efforts underway to diversify supply sources amid regional tensions. The government warns against panic buying and stresses coordinated monitoring to prevent hoarding, ensuring uninterrupted fuel access nationwide....

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Fuel dealers warn of post-Eid strike if margins not raised - Business - DAWN.COM

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Karachi faces severe gas shortages due to Qatar's LNG suspension amid Iran-Iraq tensions. Unannounced supply cuts disrupt Ramazan routines; residents turn to costly LPG/electric stoves. SSGC's lack of transparency fuels frustration, while renewables remain underutilized amid inflation and energy insecurity....

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Gulf conflict disrupts global energy: Iran’s drone strikes shut Hormuz, forcing oil exports via alternative routes. Saudi Aramco halts production; Iraq and UAE cut output sharply. LNG cuts from Qatar. Market volatility surges 60%; insurers wary of risk. US military escorts unlikely to resolve tensions without Tehran concessions. Renewables not impacted; crisis exposes supply chain fragility....

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Middle East conflict fuels massive carbon emissions—equivalent to small nations’ annual output—and pollutes air, water, soil via oil depot fires. Military operations, fuel use, and infrastructure damage exacerbate climate costs, driving energy price spikes and pressuring governments to balance economic relief with decarbonization efforts....

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Iran conflict-triggered energy price surges have boosted oil giants’ stock valuations by \$130bn+ in two weeks, with Shell, Exxon, Chevron, and BP seeing major gains. Critics urge windfall taxes to protect households, while renewables advocates warn against fuel duty cuts amid soaring profits....

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Middle East conflict disrupts global oil supplies, driving up fuel, fertiliser, and plastic costs across Australia. EV sales surge amid rising petrol prices. Interest rates may rise faster, impacting mortgages. Airfares, freight, and medical helium supplies are also affected, with recycling becoming more viable as oil prices climb....

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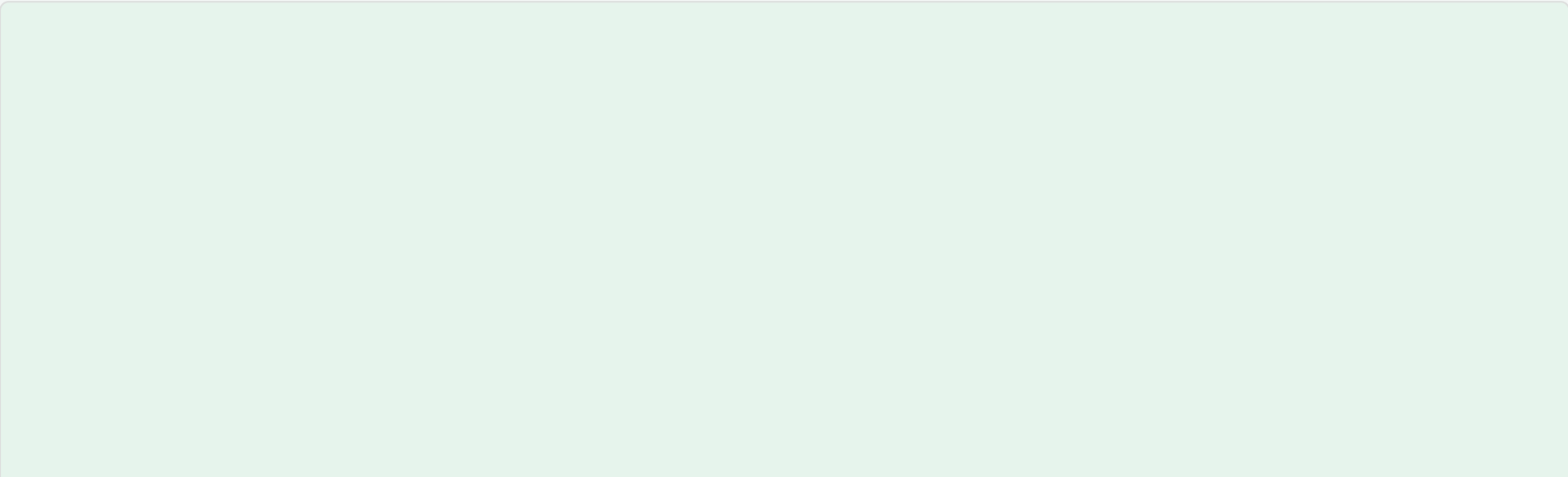
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